

Readings at the Lord's Table

In our Liturgy of the Table, we follow the progression from the written Word to the visible Word — from Scripture to the Sacrament. Three distinct reading series govern the Table, each on its own cycle, assigned according to the instructions below.

The *Lord's Discourse* is a series of 12 readings drawn from the discourses of our Lord Jesus Christ, completing a full cycle in approximately three months. It is divided into three groups: the Johannine Discourses (six readings from the Gospel of John), the Matthean Discourses (six readings from the Gospel of Matthew), and a discourse we call “Kingdom and Discipleship” (a reading from the Gospel of Luke). The assigned text for each Sunday is listed in the table below.

The *Words of Institution* rotates on a four-week monthly cycle among the four Gospel and Pauline accounts of our Lord's establishment of the Holy Supper: **Matthew 26**, **Mark 14**, **Luke 22**, and **1 Corinthians 11**. The assigned text for each Sunday is listed in the table below.

The *Closing of the Table* concludes the administration of the elements with a brief reading from the Gospels, sealing the Table with the very words of Christ. It has three assigned texts, each permanently paired to a group of Discourses: **John 17** is paired to all six Johannine Discourses; **Matthew 5:9–15** is paired to the Matthean Discourses; and **Luke 11:2–4** is paired to the Kingdom and Discipleship reading. The Closing of the Table text is therefore determined not by the calendar but by whichever Lord's Discourse is appointed for that Sunday.

See table below.

The Lord's Discourse	Words of Institution	Closing of the Table	Great Commission
John 14:1–16 <i>Farewell Discourse</i>	1st Sunday: Matthew 26:17–30	John 17	1st Sunday: John 20:21
John 3:1–21 <i>The New Birth</i>	2nd Sunday: Mark 14:12–26	John 17	2nd Sunday: Matthew 28:19–20
John 4:1–42 <i>The Water of Life</i>	3rd Sunday: Luke 22:7–21	John 17	3rd Sunday: Luke 24:46–48
Jn 5:1–47 <i>The Divine Son</i>	4th Sunday: 1 Corinthians 11:23–29	John 17	4th Sunday: Acts 1:7–8
John 6:22–69 <i>The Bread of Life</i>	1st Sunday: Matthew 26:17–30	John 17	1st Sunday: Jn 20:21
John 8:12–58 <i>The Light of the World and the Good Shepherd</i>	2nd Sunday: Mark 14:12–26	John 17	2nd Sunday: Matthew 28:19–20
Matthew 5–6:1–8, 6–34, 7:1–29 <i>The Sermon on the Mount</i>	3rd Sunday: Luke 22:7–21	Matthew 5:9–15	3rd Sunday: Luke 24:46–48
Matthew 10:1–42 <i>The Mission Discourse</i>	4th Sunday: 1 Corinthians 11:23–29	Matthew 5:9–15	4th Sunday: Acts 1:7–8
Matthew 13 <i>The Parabolic Discourse</i>	1st Sunday: Matthew 26:17–30	Matthew 5:9–15	1st Sunday: John 20:21
Matthew 18 <i>The Community Discourse</i>	2nd Sunday: Mark 14:12–26	Matthew 5:9–15	2nd Sunday: Matthew 28:19–20
Matthew 24–25 <i>The Parabolic Discourse</i>	3rd Sunday: Luke 22:7–21	Matthew 5:9–15	3rd Sunday: Luke 24:46–48
Luke 12:1–59, 15:1–32 <i>The Kingdom and Discipleship</i>	4th Sunday: 1 Corinthians 11:23–29	Luke 11:2–4	4th Sunday: Acts 1:7–8

When a 5th Sunday occurs, repeat the last Sunday's appointed texts.